

CYCLISTIC BIKE-SHARE

How Members and Casual Riders Differ

5.5M

Total Rides

12

Months

64%

Members

Data Analysis Case Study | May 2025 – April 2026

5.5M Rides Analyzed · 12 Months · BigQuery + Tableau

Executive Summary

Business Question: How do annual members and casual riders use Cyclistic bikes differently?

Total Rides Analyzed

5.5M

May 2025 – Apr 2026

Annual Members

64.7%

3.58M rides

Casual Riders

35.3%

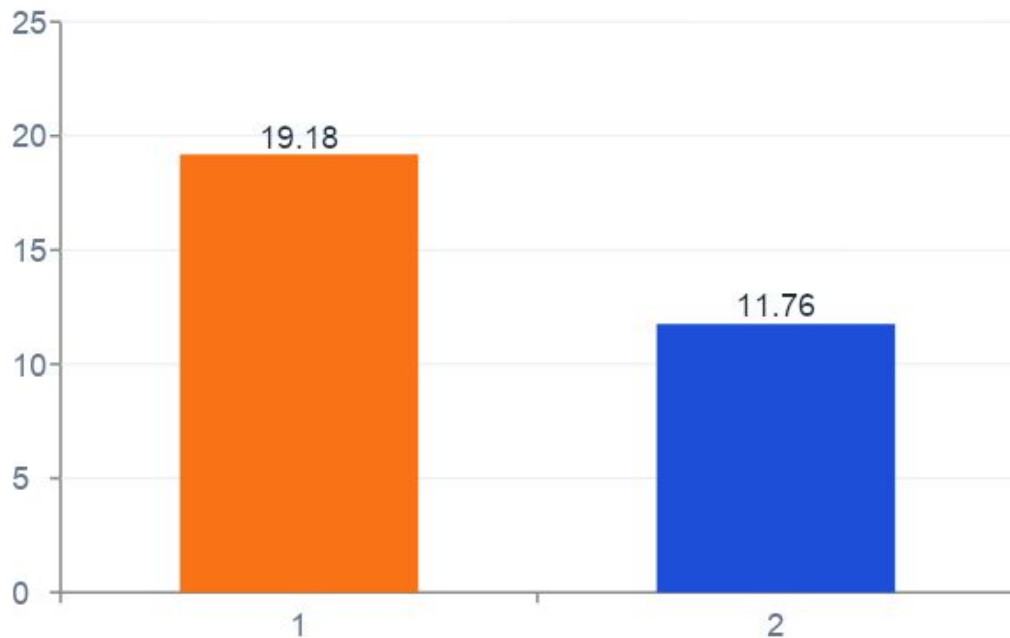
1.95M rides

KEY FINDINGS

- Casual riders take 63% longer trips (19 min vs 12 min) — leisure vs commute behaviour
- Casuals peak on weekends; members peak on Thursday — clear commuter pattern
- Casual ridership drops 93% in winter; members only drop 75% — weather-driven behaviour
- Casual top stations are tourist hotspots: Navy Pier, Millennium Park, Shedd Aquarium

Finding 1 — Ride Duration

Casual riders take significantly longer trips, suggesting leisure rather than commuting



63% longer

Casuals ride 63% longer on average than members

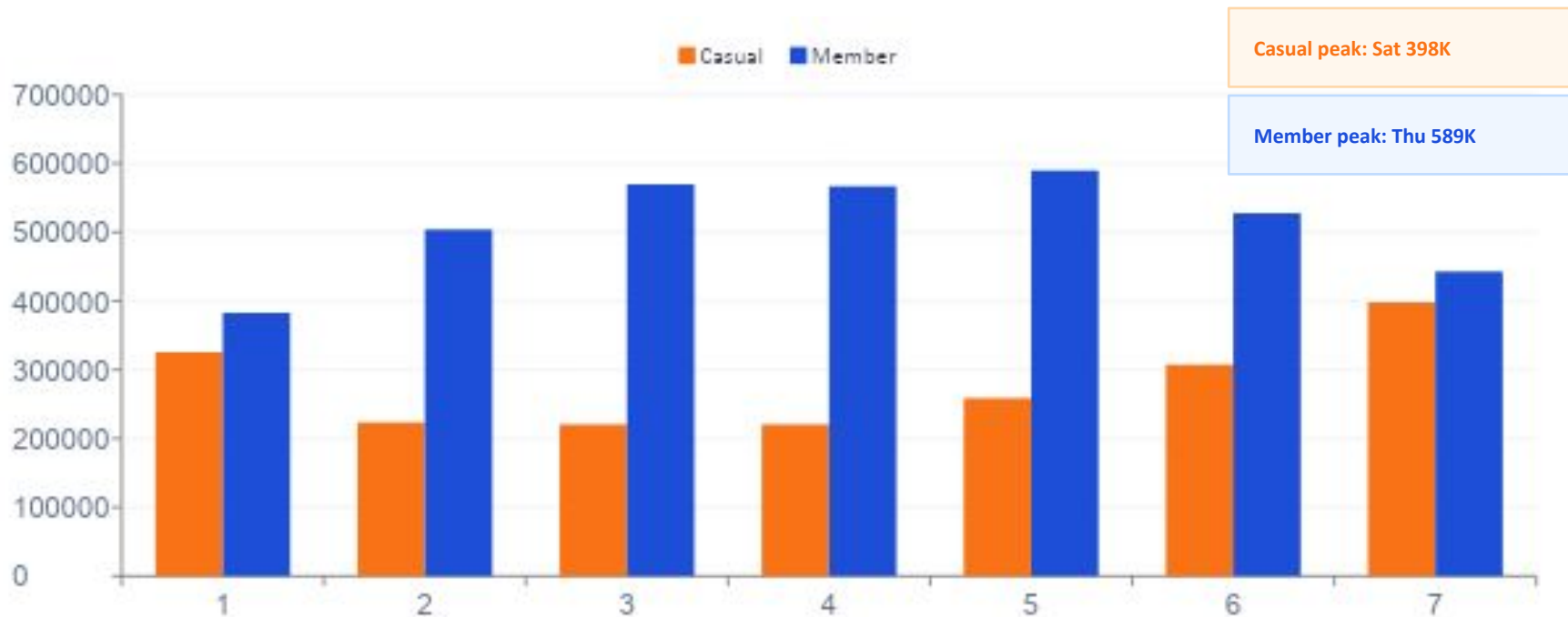
What this means:

Members use bikes for quick, efficient commutes.

Casuals use bikes for leisure exploration.

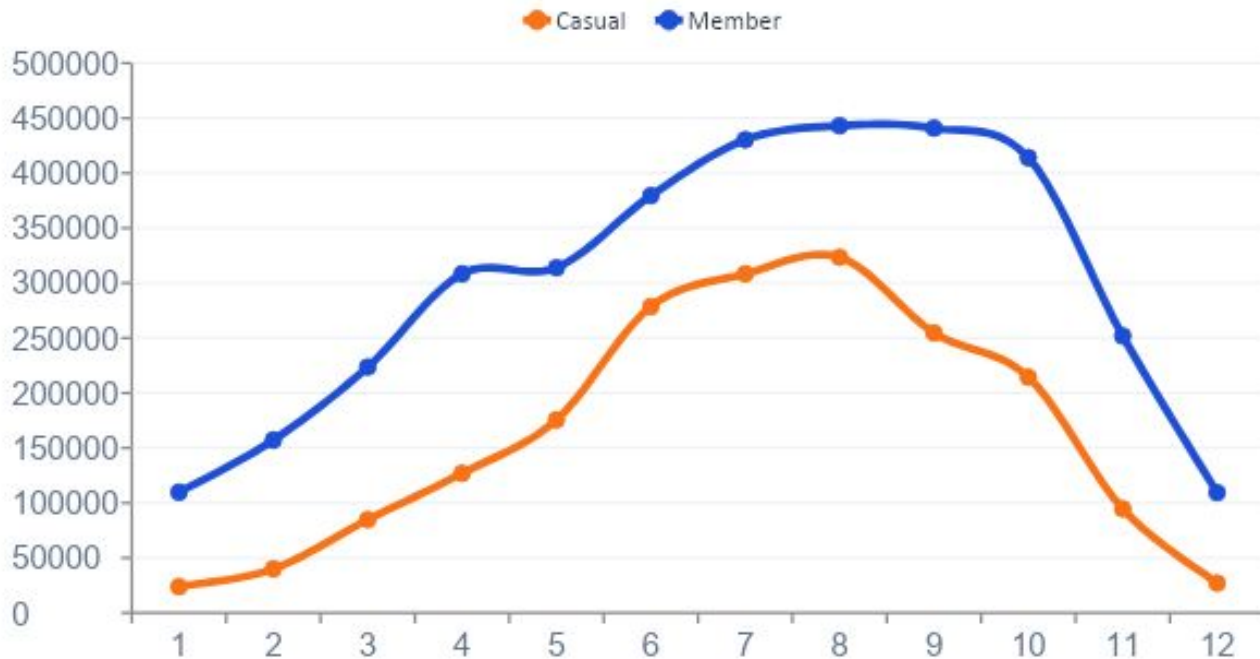
Finding 2 — Weekly Ride Patterns

Members commute on weekdays; casuals enjoy weekends



Finding 3 — Seasonal Trends

Casual riders are 4.5× more seasonal — they nearly disappear in winter



Casual — Winter Drop

93%

Jan: 23,876 vs Aug: 323,523

Member — Winter Drop

75%

Jan: 109,855 vs Aug: 443,125

Casual is more seasonal by

4.5×

Weather-driven behaviour

Finding 4 — Station Locations

Casual riders cluster at tourist destinations; members spread across the city

TOP CASUAL STATIONS

Navy Pier	32,173
DuSable Lake Shore Dr & Monroe	31,083
Michigan Ave & Oak St	22,257
DuSable Lake Shore Dr & North Blvd	19,273
Streeter Dr & Grand Ave	18,910

All tourist & lakefront locations

TOP MEMBER STATIONS

Clinton St & Washington Blvd	26,842
Kingsbury St & Kinzie St	25,197
Clark St & Elm St	24,873
Wells St & Concord Ln	23,561
Millennium Park	22,104

Transit hubs & residential commute routes

Finding 5 — Bike Type Preferences

Both groups prefer electric bikes — but casuals ride classic bikes for 28 min (pure leisure)



AVG DURATION BY BIKE TYPE

Casual — Classic Bike

28.7 min

Leisurely city exploration

Member — Classic Bike

13.4 min

Efficient commuting

Casual — Electric Bike

14.3 min

Quick tourist trips

Member — Electric Bike

10.9 min

Fast daily commutes

ACT — 3 MARKETING RECOMMENDATIONS

How to convert casual riders into annual members

01

Weekend & Summer Membership Campaign

Casuals peak Saturdays (398K rides) and August (324K). Launch a discount annual membership offer at high-traffic summer weekends. Target riders who use the service 3+ times per month — they're already engaged.

Sat 398K rides · Aug 324K rides

02

Digital Ads at Tourist Stations

Top casual stations — Navy Pier (32K), Millennium Park (19K), Shedd Aquarium (17K) — are all tourist hotspots. Place QR codes and screens showing the cost-per-ride savings of annual membership.

Navy Pier · Millennium Park · Shedd Aquarium

03

Reframe Membership as a Leisure Lifestyle

Current marketing likely promotes commuting. But casuals ride 19 min on average and use classic bikes for 29 min — they ride for fun. Reframe membership as "ride longer, explore more, pay less."

Casual avg 19 min vs Member avg 12 min

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Data Tells a Clear Story

- 1 Casual riders take 63% longer trips — they ride for fun, not commuting
- 2 Casuals are weekend riders; members are consistent weekday commuters
- 3 Casual usage drops 93% in winter — summer is the prime conversion window
- 4 Casual hotspots are tourist destinations: Navy Pier, Millennium Park
- 5 Casuals on classic bikes ride 2.1x longer than members — leisure confirmed